

Carl Christian Abrahamsen

New York University Department of Philosophy
5 Washington Place, 10003 New York, NY

Email: ca2551@nyu.edu
Website: ccabrahamsen.com

Interests

AOS: Early modern European philosophy; 19th century European philosophy; ethics

AOC: meta-ethics; aesthetics; social and political philosophy

Education

Ph.D. in Philosophy, New York University 2020 – present

Dissertation: *Sentiment and Sociality in Adam Smith's Theory of Human Nature*

Committee: Don Garrett (chair), Anja Jauernig, Sharon Street

B.A. in Philosophy and Economics (high distinction), University of Toronto 2015 – 2019

Honours Thesis: "Marx's Critique of Empiricism in *The German Ideology*"

Papers

Forthcoming. Passion and Propriety: Adam Smith's Theory of Approval.
The Philosophical Review.

Forthcoming. Sophie de Grouchy on Tragedy and the "Need to be Moved."
The Journal for the History of Philosophy.

Under review. [Paper on the love of praiseworthiness in Adam Smith]

Presentations

Smith on the Love of Praiseworthiness
Atlantic Canada Seminar in Early Modern Philosophy, Dalhousie University, 2026.

Smith on Self-Evaluation, Sentiment, and Being a 'Stranger to Society'
NYC Workshop on Early Modern Philosophy, Fordham University, 2024.

Sophie de Grouchy on the 'Need to be Moved'
NYU Workshop on the History of Modern Philosophy, 2022.

Sophie de Grouchy on Tragedy as the 'Exercise of the Soul'
UC San Diego Modern Philosophy Graduate Workshop, 2022.

Adam Smith on Empathy with the Dead
Washington Square Circle, New York University, 2021.

Teaching Experience

As lead instructor:

Early Modern European Philosophy, NYU	2026
Introduction to Aesthetics, NYU	2024
Early Modern European Philosophy, NYU	2023

As teaching assistant:

Texts and Ideas: Sin and Guilt; Law and Justice, NYU (Tim Maudlin)	2026
Philosophy of Mind, NYU (Ned Block)	2024
The Nature of Values, NYU (Sanford Diehl)	2023
Early Modern Philosophy, NYU (Tim Maudlin)	2023
Texts and Ideas: Why Art Matters, NYU (Robert Hopkins)	2022
Introduction to Logic, NYU (grader, Verónica Gómez Sánchez)	2022
Introduction to Philosophy, University of Toronto (Jim John)	2018 – 2019

High school outreach:

East Side Community High School (with Corrupt the Youth)	2024 – 2026
High School of Art and Design	2021
Broome High School Philosophy Club	2021 – 2022

Service Roles

Co-Organizer, Washington Square Circle (NYU graduate work-in-progress group)	2021 – 2022 and 2025 – 2026
Graduate Student Organizer, NYU Philosophy Curriculum Committee	2024 – 2025
Organizer, NYU Workshop on the History of Modern Philosophy	2022 – 2025
Graduate Student Organizer, NYU Colloquium Committee	2023 – 2024
Graduate Student Mentor	2021 – 2022
Co-Organizer, Columbia-NYU Graduate Conference in Philosophy	2020-2021
Referee for <i>Archiv für Geschichte der Philosophie</i>	

Awards and Scholarships

Dean's Dissertation Fellowship	2025 – 2026
Henry M. MacCracken fellowship	2020 – 2025
Regents Graduating Award	2019
John Macdonald Scholarship in Philosophy	2017
Jackman Humanities Scholar-in-Residence	2017
University of Toronto International Scholar	2015 – 2019

Selected Graduate Coursework

History of Philosophy (“*” = audited)

- Aristotle’s Metaphysics (Marko Malink and Jessica Moss)
- Compassion in the History of Ethics (Anja Jauernig)
- Theories of Recognition: Hegel and Marx (Jake McNulty)
- Rationalism in the 17th Century (Don Garrett)
- Moral Sentimentalism* (Don Garrett)
- Hume’s A Treatise on Human Nature* (Don Garrett)

Value Theory (“*” = audited)

- Aesthetics (Rob Hopkins and Anja Jauernig)
- Metaethics (Sharon Street)
- Rawls & Race (Samuel Scheffler)
- Metaethics and the Self* (Sharon Street)
- Responding to Wrongdoing* (Miranda Fricker)
- Love and Respect* (Sanford Diehl)

Last updated: October 2026